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Free Downloads for every PC user

AVG 6.0 Free

01

Code red

Viruses spread either through file sharing media or through the Internet. Never to be taken lightly, it's always wise to protect your PC from these dreadful pieces of code. AVG 6.0 from Grisoft is the best free anti-virus software around. The powerful scanning engine, Virus Stalker, provides solid protection against file and e-mail viruses with its heuristic abilities. Whether your PC is already infected and requires a thorough cleaning, or you wish to prevent any possibilities of an infection, AVG should give you that much needed Z-class security. With regular engine and database updates and the ability to scan zipped files and remote network folders, this anti-virus solution comes with its own doctor.

Freeware; www.grisoft.com

IrfanView 3.61

02

Software with a view

Images speak louder than words. If you own a PC, you would have definitely gone on a hunt for a J-Lo wallpaper at some point in time. And, of course, you don't have to wait till the next family reunion to check out the photographs from the last bash. The varieties of image formats available today make an image viewer an absolute necessity. The ideal image viewer ought to be light, provide support for a wide range of image formats, and also give you basic image editing features. IrfanView is a beautiful piece of software that accomplishes all this and more. Whether you need to do batch processing or scan an image and apply Photoshop filter effects, or even play MP3 and video files—IrfanView has all the answers.

Freeware; www.irfanview.com

WinZip 8.1

03

Packed to perfection

Archival/compression utilities are essential in every PC user's arsenal. You need them every time you have to transfer large files over the Internet or to another computer. WinZip is the most popular compression utility available for download and with good reason. Not only does it satisfy the standard for ease-of-use, but also includes other neat features like performing a virus scan (using your default anti-virus software) without actually extracting the files, password protection, splitting large archives into smaller chunks, and so on. It is a great archival tool. The only real downside is the nagging splash screen, which pops up every time you try to zip or unzip a file with the evaluation copy.

Shareware; www.winzip.com

Winamp 2.78

04

Turntable for your PC

Music brings the world together and MP3s are the most popular standard for music lovers worldwide. Just add a soundcard and speakers and the PC is transformed into a modern jukebox. Winamp from Nullsoft has been synonymous with MP3s for as long as anyone can remember. The most popular MP3 player around is a free download and offers a set of intuitive controls, a skinnable interface (you can find scores of skins online), and also lets you create your own playlists. Features such as low memory footprint and plugins that do everything—from optimising sound output for headphones to gripping visualisations—set Winamp apart. Simply the best free player available.

Freeware; www.winamp.com

So you've got a new PC? Great, but what will your PC do without the best downloads? Get these absolutely free software now!

True happiness is a brand new multimedia PC sitting in your bedroom, waiting to take you on a journey of colour, an extravaganza of sound, to a dreamland—akin to Alice in Wonderland. But in order to exploit your PC's true potential, you need the best software. We have handpicked 10 essential software, each of which tops the features' list in its category. So put the hustle behind your PC's muscle with these freely downloadable, must-have utilities. 

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